



Eclipse SDV Hackathon Guide Book

2026 EDITION

Innovation • Collaboration • Open Source

Eclipse SDV Hackathon Guide Book

1. General participation & governance

This section applies to all attendees, including participants, coaches, and staff.

Core Philosophy: We welcome attendees from all backgrounds to foster a diverse environment of student energy and professional expertise.

Capacity & Team Structure:

- Maximum attendance is capped at 50 people.
- Teams must consist of a maximum of 5 people.
- Participants may sign up as a pre-formed team or join one during the on-site team formation session.

Equipment: All participants are required to bring their own computer with a standard laptop configuration.

Code of Conduct: Every stakeholder must adhere to the [Eclipse Community Code of Conduct](#). We provide a harassment-free experience regardless of background and do not tolerate unacceptable behavior such as trolling, derogatory comments, or public harassment. Participants violating these rules may be sanctioned or expelled from the event at the discretion of the organizers. Instances of abusive, harassing, or otherwise unacceptable behavior may be reported by contacting codeofconduct@eclipse.org. All complaints will be reviewed and investigated and will result in a response that is deemed necessary and appropriate to the circumstances.

2. Registration

All participants are required to register officially to confirm their attendance. Please visit the [Hackathon registration page](#) to complete the process.

3. Dual-track competition structure (2026)

For the 2026 edition, the event is split into two distinct cultures to address both: innovation and project stability.

The event will run two parallel, co-located tracks. Participants have to choose their track on Day 1 after the official challenge presentations. Additional adjustments or changes after Day 1 will not be accepted. While separate

competitions are maintained for fair evaluation, collaboration between tracks is highly encouraged.

All code must be created during the duration of the Hackathon. (Note: within the HackFest/freestyle track all prepared code must be declared clearly and presented on the end of the first day to the HackMC)

Track Feature	Hackathon Track (Innovation Track)	2. Hackfest Track (Freestyle track)
Audience	Students, young developers, newcomers to the ecosystem	Professionals, core contributors, and project experts
Focus	Building innovative edge applications supported by a business case . "Everything that serves a specific business idea!"	Project integration and innovation, new project features, and interfacing multiple projects. "Everything that brings the Eclipse SDV Projects forward!"
Primary deliverables	A business pitch deck and a (working) application demo Extra technology points possible with using specific listed technologies.	Real(!) Eclipse Project Pull Requests (PRs) submitted to the repositories or filed Eclipse SDV Blueprints issues (as the Blueprints process describes)
Success metrics	Classical business pitch and solution capability, code maturity and technical expertise	Quality of PR submissions, code maturity, issue resolution count, and technical expertise

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Clear definitions ensure all stakeholders understand their unique value to the ecosystem.

Participants: Responsible for delivering a "Solution Plan" by 6 PM on Day 1, which includes their team's core idea and development process.

Hack coaches: Experts who mentor teams. They are responsible for evaluating the technical brilliance and impact categories during an 8-minute interview and live demo on the morning of Day 3. HackCoaches reserve explicit time slots for the Hackathon Teams. In the time when they are "free" they can do their work.

Jury members: A panel of 5–7 members who evaluate the finalist teams on pitching and creativity. Jury members may be affiliated with organisations that have participating teams. To ensure fairness, jury members will not evaluate teams from their own organisation. Final scores will be based on the aggregated assessments of the remaining jury members.

Hack MC & Assistant: Lead the moderation, introduce challenges, and support teams and coaches throughout the event. Decide on the number of finalist teams on Day 1

5. Evaluation criteria & milestones

Evaluation criteria

Evaluation criteria is fully described in the Eclipse SDV Hackathon Evaluation Forms.

You can download the document here: <https://github.com/Eclipse-SDV-Hackathon-Chapter-Four>

Key Deadlines:

- Day 1 (6 PM): Deliver Solution Plan to coaches.
- Day 3 (9 AM–10:30 AM): Technical interviews/demos with Hack Coaches.
- Day 3 (12 PM): Final pitching slides must be uploaded.

Overview of the evaluation journey (Hackathon)

To ensure a fair, transparent, and structured competition, all participating teams must progress through three mandatory evaluation checkpoints across the 3-day event. Failure to meet the respective deadlines or criteria at any stage can impact a team's overall evaluation and standing.

Step 1: Deliver your solution plan (Day 1)

All teams must submit their official Solution Plan to the Hack Coaches by no later than 18:00 PM on the first day. This document acts as your team's project declaration and alignment check. It must include the following two main sections:

1. Your Team at a Glance

- Identity: Who are you? Provide a brief, catchy tagline or team name.
- Roster: List all team members along with their respective GitHub Handles.
- Responsibilities: Define clear roles within the team (if dedicated roles have been assigned).
- Challenge Alignment: Clearly declare the specific challenge you have decided to compete for.
- Core Idea: Outline a summary of your rough solution idea.

2. How Do You Work?

- Development process (Light): Explain your framework for project planning

- and progress tracking.
- Detail how you intend to ensure proper quality control (e.g., testing strategies, document management, code reviews).
- Team communication: Detail how the team will communicate effectively under time-sensitive constraints.
- Decision making: Outline your strategy for handling internal bottlenecks or resolving design disagreements.

Step 2: Technical interview by Hack Coaches (Day 3)

On the morning of Day 3, teams will face a rigorous, deep-dive technical assessment conducted directly by our ecosystem experts.

- A panel of Hack Coaches will evaluate your project. The evaluation at this stage is strictly focused on two primary grading pillars: technical brilliance and impact.
- Duration: Each team receives an exact 8-minute interview window.
- Scheduling: Time slots for the interview will be assigned to the Teams on Day2
- Attendance strategy: Each team can send only 1 or 2 designated members or the full Team to represent them in the live interview room. The rest of the team members are required to remain at their hacking stations to continue formatting presentation decks or refining deliverables.
- The Finalist selection: Following the completion of all technical interviews, the Hack Coaches will consolidate scores to select a total number of 7 finalist teams combined across both event locations.

Step 3: Final pitch in front of the jury (Day 3)

The concluding phase of the evaluation brings the top teams to the main stage for high-stakes presentation grading.

- Only the selected finalist teams will advance to this stage to present live.
- Our main executive Jury panel will judge the finalists specifically on the remaining core categories: pitching and creativity.
- Timeline:
 - Pitch time: Strictly capped at 10 minutes per team.
 - Jury Q&A: A 5-minute window following the pitch for direct questions from the Jury members.

Chronological Event Milestones		
Day 1	11:30 AM - 12:30 PM	Team & Challenge Selection: Teams are officially finalized and challenges are chosen
	6:00 PM	Solution Plan Submission: Teams must submit their brief plan detailing "Team at a Glance" (members, GitHub handles, catchy tagline, chosen challenge, rough idea) and "How We Work" (process, tracking, communication, and QA strategy)
Day 2	All day	Intensive Hacking & Cross-Track Interaction: Multi-track mixing during presentations and networking events
	Evening	Networking dinner (with BBQ)
Day 3	8:00 AM	Code Freeze: Deadline for final project and code repository uploads
	9:00 AM - 10:30 AM	Hack Coach Technical Interviews: Teams undergo a strict 8-minute technical interview evaluated by a panel of coaches.
	12:00 PM	Pitch Deck Submission: Final pitch slide upload! deadline
	11:00 AM - 12:30 PM	Finalist Pitching Sessions: The selected finalist teams pitch live to the main Jury (10 minutes pitch, 5 minutes Q&A)

6. Logistics

- **Venue logistics & "Survival" information:** The venue is open from 08:00 (8AM) until 22:00 (10PM)
 - *There is a locked room participants could use for storing some small items. Contact OnSite Staff*
- **Catering & dietary accommodations:** We should state what meals are provided (e.g., "All meals, snacks, and drinks from Tuesday morning to Thursday afternoon are covered") and instructions on how/where to declare severe allergies or dietary restrictions (Vegan, Halal, Gluten-Free).
- **Travel & accommodation recommendations:** Getting there, also information for students how they will be reimbursed in regards to the registration fee.

7. Rewards and Recognition

- Main Prizes: Awarded for first places based on the highest cumulative scores.
- Hack Coach Benefits: Coaches receive special digital badges, exclusive SWAG, and recognition on the website for their expert contributions.

8. "Help & Support" escalation matrix:

When a team's environment crashes at 2:00 AM, who do they contact?

- As a main communication channel we will use Slack - the [#ask-a-hackcoach](#) Slack channel for technical bugs, [#hackathon2026](#) for venue or any other general issues.

Our Team is less than 5 persons, how do we connect upfront with others?

- As a main communication channel we will use Slack - the Slack channel for general questions is [#hackathon2026](#). There you can open a new thread for forming a full team upfront.

Is it allowed to prepare work?

- It makes sense to prepare yourself and your development environment upfront, but keep in mind that EVERYTHING you prepare outside the Hackathon, needs to be declared on Day 1 to the HackMC (in person). If you have a nice Business Idea upfront, you can use this Idea, but keep in mind that you need to create all assets while the Ha